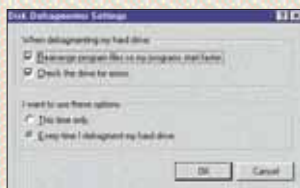


DoubleBuffer to 0. You can disable logging of the boot process by setting the value of DisableLog to 1. Setting SystemReg to 0 will disable scanning of the Registry at startup, but it is better to leave this on.

Defragmenting to rearrange programs

Windows 98 has a pretty useful feature to help load applications faster—over time, it tracks your usage patterns and logs the frequency with which you use each application. It can then rearrange the files of the application on your hard drive so that they will load faster. After you have used your computer for a few weeks, run the Disk Defragmenter and select the drive you want to defragment (usually C). Click Set-

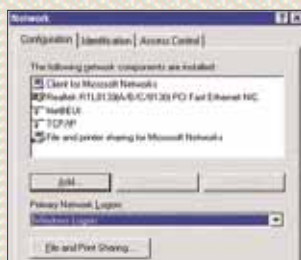


Defragment the hard disk to rearrange programs

tings and check the box to 'Rearrange program files so my programs start faster'. Plus, you also have the added advantage of the disk getting defragmented.

Windows logon

If you are not on a network and Windows is not configured for multiple users, or network users are not authenticated by an NT domain, you should turn off the Windows logon dialog



Log on to Windows automatically

box. Open **Control Panel > Network** to configure the network properties. You don't require the Microsoft Family Logon, so select it and click Remove. Ensure that the Primary Network Logon is Windows Logon and click OK. If you don't have any password for the user, Windows will automatically log on without the prompt. If you did set a password, you can locate and delete the PWL file from the Windows folder, restart Windows and this time enter a blank password.

Using Tweak UI

Tweak UI is a very powerful software that lets you change various system settings without having to edit system files or fiddle with the Registry. It is free and can be downloaded from www.microsoft.com/networkstation/downloads/PowerToys/Networking/NTTweakUI.asp. Version 1.33 is a consolidated version that will work on Windows 9x as well as NT systems—it will give you different options on different OSes. After it is installed, it will be available from the Control Panel. Using Tweak UI is pretty straightforward, but here are

a few changes you must make to get better performance.

Under the General tab, disable Window animation, Smooth scrolling, Menu animation, Combo box animation and List box animation. On the Explorer tab, disable 'Animated Click here to begin'. Next, switch to the IE4 tab and disable 'Active Desktop enabled'. On the Boot tab, you can control boot settings such as the behaviour of the boot menu, Scandisk, etc. Autorun for



Use Tweak UI to speed up Windows 98

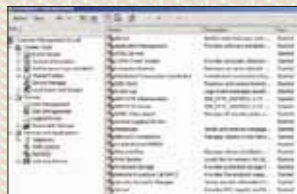
be disabled under the Paranoia tab.

WINDOWS 2000 PROFESSIONAL

Windows 2000 lacks little in terms of performance and stability, but can be squeezed for even more juice

Get rid of services

Services are background applications that run on Windows. They may be system-related programs without which Windows cannot run, or helper applications, providing certain functionality to other programs. For example, the Security Accounts Manager service stores security information for user accounts to be used by all applications for authentication. Windows 2000 starts several services by default, many of which you may not require. You can either permanently disable a service, or set it to be manual-



Stop services you don't require

ly started. If you are unsure, choose the Manual mode—the service will be started only when required, but will not cause any errors. If permanently disabled, dependent programs will throw up errors when they need the service.

Right-click My Computer and click Manage. On the left pane, expand Services and Applications and click Services. Sort the services in descending order by the Status column to bring the services that are currently running on top. You can select each service and double-click it to read its description, change the Startup type to Manual or Disabled and to stop it. As you go through the list, you may realise that you don't require more than half the services, such as Distributed File System, Task Scheduler, Remote Registry Service,